Gabriel Applauds $6M in Security Grants for the Valley

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Do You Have"Eldest Daughter Syndrome?"

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ENCINO ENTERPRISE

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NEWS IN BRIEF

Friends of the LA River Earth Day Event April 20

Friends of the LA River, alongside volunteers at the Encino Neighborhood Council, will gather for their Earth Day event on Saturday, April 20, from 8 am to 12 pm at the Sepulveda Basin Wildlife Reserve (6350 Woodley Ave). Join them for a morning of habitat restoration removing invasive plant species, create and take home handmade seedballs and partake on a nature walk along the reserve with the San Fernando Valley Audubon Society. RSVP to this free event at support.folar.org/event/earth-day-habitat-restore-and-renew/e565781.

Hope of the Valley Expanding to Encino?

Hope of the Valley, now known as Hope the Mission, has proposed an expansion into Encino with conversion of the Rodeway Inn (also known as Oak Tree Inn) into housing for "at risk youth" who may be aging out of the foster care system. Currently the hotel at 17448 Ventura Blvd. at Encino Avenue is a 9,286-square-foot building with a two-story center and two one-story wings with 65 rooms. The hotel was built in 1949 and recently remodeled in 2018. Founded in 2009, Hope of the Valley Rescue Mission began as a small ministry run out of Sun Valley where volunteers cooked and served hot meals to homeless men, women and children.

Tarzana Music Night April 26

Join Tarzana Community and Cultural Center for another "Music Night Live" on Friday, April 26, from 7 to 10 pm. Performers include Tracy Newman, Art Podell, Brent Hahn, Kevin Kelso, Kathleen Kelso, Kim Margolis, Claire Bloom, Dr. Generous, Dave Morrison, Karen Turner, James Combs & Erin Hawkins, Justin Richard, Steven Wagner and Annette Adler. Special guest JaKL will perform a 20-minute set at 8 pm. The show will be outdoors and refreshments will be available for purchase. Tickets are $5 at the door or through mytarzana.org.

Day of Service Creates "World's Largest Lasagna" to Feed Angelenos in Need



Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel, center, his son Joshua (6), and volunteers help prepare "The World's Largest Lasagna" — 22,000 servings of lasagna for Angelenos in need.

Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel was joined by over 1,300 volunteers, 50 community groups, and other elected officials on April 14 to participate in nearly 20 service projects across the San Fernando Valley as part of the Assemblymember's Third Annual Valley Day of Service.

"While social media is often filled with negativity, the truth is we are lucky to have such a generous and caring community in the San Fernando Valley," said Assemblymember Gabriel. "I am grateful for all of the amazing volunteers who turned out despite the rain to make this Day of Service such a success, and I am thankful for the wonderful community organizations that help make a positive difference in the Valley every day of the year."

Projects at the Valley Day of Service included:

-Assembling of "The World's Largest Lasagna" by preparing 22,000 meals for Angelenos in need with Hope the Mission.

-Packing 2,000 homeless outreach kits with LA Family Housing and Jewish Family Service LA.





Above: Volunteers making 1,000 sandwiches for lunch bags for various Valley nonprofits. Sandwiches sponsored by Project Rise of Dawoodi Bohra. At right: Gabriel with Laure Stevens, the Encino Neighborhood Council Area 6 Representative, Secretary and Traffic Committee Chair.

-Making 1,000 sandwiches for those experiencing hunger with Project Rise for West Valley Food Pantry, About My Father's Business, First United Methodist Church Kingdom Food Pantry, and Hope the Mission

-Writing over 1,000 letters to seniors at ONEgeneration, health care workers at Valley Presbyterian Hospital, and cancer patients at City of Hope.

-Crafting 1,000 paracord bracelets for active duty service members with Operation Gratitude and assembling more than 600 tote bags for seniors at ONEgeneration.

-Cleaning up the Sepulveda Basin with Volunteers Cleaning Communities.

-Planting fruit trees with Tree People and the San Fernando Valley Rose Society at the Hope the Mission family shelter.

-Beautifying and renovating the New Economics for Women campus in Canoga Park.

-Preparing a community mural with Arts Bridging the Gap at the West Valley YMCA in Reseda.

-Training more than 100 volunteers in CPR with the American Red Cross.

-Hosting a blood drive with Cedars-Sinai to donate 36 pints of blood.

-Planting a new native plant garden with the Santa Monica Mountains Fund and San Fernando Valley Audubon Society at the Mid Valley YMCA.

- Crafting 35 blankets for survivors of domestic violence at Haven Hills.

-Helping to find a new home for eight dogs adopted from Foxy and the Hounds.

CALENDAR

There are better ways to get acquainted.



As a local business, you're always looking to meet new contacts and find ways to grow your business. The Sherman Oaks/Encino Chamber of Commerce offers easy, fun and useful ways to make new connections and find new resources. Got a problem? Need some help?

We're here to get you what you need to succeed. Call us today at 818-906-1951 or email us at hello@shermanoaksencinochamber.org.

Learn what we can do for you.

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BLINTZES AND BURRITOS BRUNCH

CONNECTING THE JEWISH AND LATINO COMMUNITIES THROUGH ART AND ARCHITECTURE

SUNDAY, MAY 5, 2024

11:00 a.m. - 2:00 p.m.

at the Rose Goldwater Community Center
21710 Vanowen St., Canoga Park

Valley Jewish Community Center's Annual Fundraiser to help provide a home for social, educational, and recreational programs for families and individuals that express Jewish values.

A CINCO DE MAYO CELEBRATION FEATURING:





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Granada Hills, CA 91344
(818) 360-2211 • info@valleyjcc.org
www.ValleyJCC.org



Community Calendar

* The Encino Neighborhood Council will hold their monthly board meeting on Wednesday, April 24, from 7 to 9 pm. Officer Walia will be attending to answer any community questions. The Zoom link will be posted in the agenda on encinonc.org 72 hours before the scheduled meeting.

* The Gelb Scholarship Foundation is offering $1000 scholarships to students who are attending a university, college or trade school in the San Fernando Valley. Scholarship consideration is based on the student's financial need and community involvement. Applications must be submitted between May 15 and June 1. For more information and applications visit gelbgroup.net/community.

* The Sherman Oaks Encino Chamber of Commerce will hold their next "Mix & Mingle" on Tuesday, April 23, from 5:30 to 7 pm at Buvette (15005 Ventura Blvd.) Make business connections and meet new people over lite bites (no host bar). Register by April 22 and the cost is $20 for members and $30 for guests. Prices go up $10 after April 22.

* Don't miss an opportunity for a free, private consultation with a Certified Financial Planner™ on a variety of personal financial issues, including debt management, retirement planning, investment strategies, income taxes, insurance and estate planning, among many others. The Financial Planning Association will present at the Encino Tarzana Library on Saturday, April 20, from 10 to 11 am, followed by one-on-one appointments from 11 am to 1 pm. Those interested are asked to call 213-228-7140 to make an appointment.

* Southern California Garden Club will present its 57th flower show, "Nature's Forces," on Saturday, April 27, from 9 am to 1:30 pm. This is the club's most important annual educational and fundraising event and will include a plant market, bake sale, floral designs and more. Free admission at the Sepulveda Garden Center on 16633 Magnolia Blvd.

* ARTIST CO-OP 7 will present "Touch of H'art," an exhibit showcasing the work of six local artists at Encino Terrace Lobby Gallery, on view now through September 28. Each artist offers their own distinctive vision and interpretation of the natural world through powerful imagery and evocative color, bringing together imagination and inspiration. On view are over 50 works by Susan Ahdoot, Selina Cheng, Beverly Engelberg, Cheryl Mann, Debbi Saunders and Joi T. Wilson. The show is curated by Helen Kim, M.A. Encino Terrace Lobby Gallery is located at 15821 Ventura Blvd and open from Monday to Friday, 7 am to 7 pm; Saturday, 9 am to 1 pm; closed Sundays.

* Save the date! The third annual Valley Asian and Pacific Islander Cultural Festival will take place on Saturday, May 4, from 10 to 4 pm at Pierce College. There will be food, fun and entertainment!

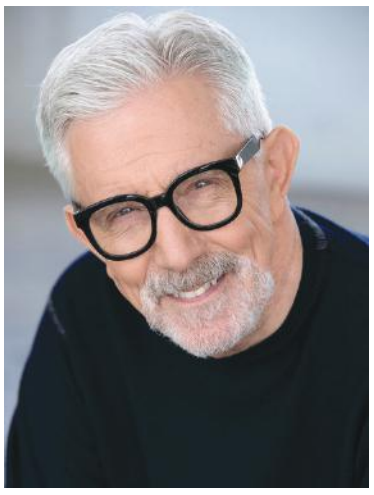
* The California Art League (aka "CAL") will host a discussion on plein air painting led by Chuck Kovacic, a celebrated local artist whose work has been exhibited all over the world, on Tuesday, April 23, from 7 to 9 pm. Kovacic will be painting a demo while sharing his methods, materials, and experiences with the audience. This all-ages event is just $5 per person at the door of the Tarzana Community and Cultural Center. RSVP to norakgroups@gmail.com.

* Rashin Kheiriyeh, a multi-award-winning author-illustrator, animator and painter will give an author talk at the Encino Tarzana Library on Monday. April 22, from 4 to 5 pm. Her children's books have been published in at least 12 countries and she is the character artist of the most popular animation series on national television in Iran called *Shekarestan (Sugarland)*. Participants attending the program will have an opportunity to receive a free copy of *Rumi Poet of Joy and Love!*

People in the News



Chamber board member **Gordon Morris** and CEO **Vickie Bourdas-Martinez** oversee the installation of new signage for the newly merged Sherman Oaks/Encino Chamber of Commerce. The offices are now combined at the former Encino Chamber's 4933 Balboa Blvd. location. The chamber recently installed its new board of directors and its slate of monthly and annual activities is underway! The new board of directors includes Tammy Scher, Jessica Swine, Fran Kerzner, Gordon Morris, Frank Rojas, Al Santillo, Alex Ezzati, Carson Schreiber, Christine Nam, Horace H. Heidt, Jason Dyer, Joel Simon, Lou Woolf, Marci Marks, Matthew Pondella and Sarah Horvet.



Emmy Award-Winning comedian and weathercaster **Fritz Coleman** (above) will receive the Media Award at The Valley Economic Alliance 26th Annual Valley of the Stars Awards Gala. The gala is presented by Bechtel Infrastructure Corporation, April 25, from 5:30 to 8:30 pm at Hilton Los Angeles/Universal City.

The Media Award is given to a media figure who contributes to the vitality of the Valley. Coleman is a five-time Emmy award-winning stand-up comedian and former NBC Weathercaster.

"I'm so happy to be honored by the Valley Economic Alliance," says Coleman. "I've been aware of their great work for a long time. I've been a resident for over 40 years…raised three children and spent nearly my entire career in the Valley. This will be a wonderful, full-circle moment for me."

Tickets for the gala are on sale at economicalliance.org/gala2024.

English Channel

By Rodger Sterling

English Channel offers the best of the late editor Rodger Sterling's columns that ran continuously in the local papers since 1968.



* A faithful reader chimed in with this musing most of us over a certain age can agree with. He says, "I'm at the age where my mind firmly believes it's 35, my humor suggests I'm 12 and my body possibly died in the Civil War.

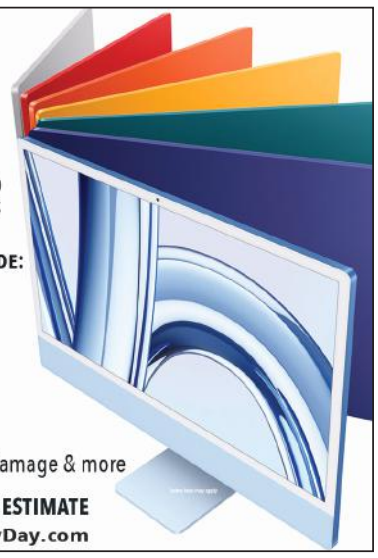
* If a cow doesn't produce milk, is it a milk dud or an udder failure?

*The three things you can always count on to tell the truth are small children, drunk people and yoga pants.

* There is a local matron who will go unnamed, who's on her fourth marriage. The first was to a millionaire, the second to an actor, the third to a preacher and now she's married to an undertaker. When asked about it she reported that she was just living a well planned life. "One for the money, two for the show, three to get ready and four to go!"

* What's the difference between the bird flu and the swine flu? One requires tweetment and the other requires oinkment!

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A Note from ENC Rep Sautter: Celebrating Earth Day



By Josh Sautter

This Earth Day, let's think about how we can keep our childhood enthusiasm for nature and animals alive into adulthood. It's not just about raising kids; it's about all of us staying positive and proactive in making our world a better place.

For the past 20 months, I've been figuring out how to instill a love of the environment in my son, Nathan, and how to stay optimistic and kind in today's world without just being overly naive.

Often, we grow up being told that our fascination with nature is something we should grow out of. But what if we didn't? What if we kept our early awe for animals, trees, and all parts of nature and openly expressed our affection and sadness when we lose them?

At our home near Balboa Park, nature is a big part of everyday life. Nathan's early words were about the animals he sees, and our family life includes frequent encounters with local wildlife.

The loss of four mature cypress trees in our neighborhood recently was a harsh reminder of how some people prioritize property over nature. These trees weren't just plants; they were a community of animals' home, and their removal really highlighted how some neighbors value their own interests over our shared natural heritage.

This Earth Day, why not take a little time to look around and really see the wildlife and trees in your area? Appreciate the natural shelter they provide and think about how much they add to our lives. Even though technology tends to isolate us, it can also connect us. This Earth Day, let's use it to reconnect with nature and each other, creating a community that cherishes and protects our beautiful planet. Let's find those small moments of connection and get a clearer view of how we fit into the bigger picture of our world.

Sautter is an Area Rep for the ENC and Chairman of the Outreach Committee. Sign up for his Substack at joshlistens.substack.com.

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Top California Laws Impacting Business in 2024

by Janice L. Miller, Esq

California continues to implement regulations significantly impacting businesses across various industries. It is crucial for businesses operating in the Golden State to stay informed about the latest legal landscape to ensure compliance and mitigate risks. Here are some top California laws and regulations shaping the business environment in 2024—employers and business owners, take note.



Corporate Transparency Act (CTA): Governing all of the U.S. is the CTA. Enacted in 2021, it took effect on January 1, 2024, with a primary objective to establish a reporting mandate for a wide range of U.S. and foreign-based entities and trusts. The core purpose of the CTA is to strengthen the ongoing battle against complex financial crimes and corruption, encompassing everything from money laundering, tax evasion, corruption, terrorist financing, and even human trafficking. Building upon the Anti-Money Laundering Act of 2020, it is a step forward in promoting financial integrity and transparency.

On March 1, 2024, however, the U.S. District Court for the District of Alabama declared the CTA unconstitutional. Judge Liles C. Burke ruled that it "transcends the limits imposed by the Constitution on the legislative branch and lacks a strong connection to any enumerated power to serve as a necessary or appropriate means to achieve Congress' policy objectives."

This is certainly not the end of the CTA. There is sure to be another appeal of this decision in the future.

The end of non-compete clauses: Starting January 1, 2024, California enforced Senate Bill 699 and Assembly Bill 1076, further clamping down on employers' ability to restrict their workforce's future employment opportunities. It establishes that non-compete agreements violate Section 16600. With the new law, employers are forbidden from binding employees or potential hires to such contracts. This is not just limited to California—any non-compete signed outside the state borders, or for roles maintained elsewhere, will be deemed unenforceable.

Sick leave expansion: Senate Bill 616 amends California's current sick paid leave from three days or 24 hours to five days or 40 hours. Effective January 1, 2024, the law covers all employees in California with employees given two options to provide paid sick leave: upfront or accrual.

Pre-employment cannabis screening: SB 700 prohibits employers from conducting pre-employment drug screenings for cannabis as well as barring companies from penalizing workers for their off-the-clock cannabis use. Measure AB 2188, passed in 2022, takes effect at the same time, making it unlawful for employers to "discriminate" against a person in hiring, termination, or any term or condition of employment based upon (1) their use of cannabis off-the-clock and off the premises; and (2) failing a workplace drug test that only detects inactive cannabis compounds. However, the law prohibits workers from using cannabis while on the job.

Workplace violence law: Effective July 1, 2024, this new law requires any California employer with at least one worker to "establish, implement, and maintain" a workplace violence prevention plan, conduct annual workplace violence prevention training, and keep an incident log of violent occurrences in the workplace.

Wage changes: The state minimum wage increased to $16 per hour from $15.50 per hour on January 1. Additionally, AB 1228, raises the minimum wage for CA fast food restaurant workers to $20 an hour starting April 1, 2024.

As California and the federal government continue to enact progressive legislation across various sectors of society, businesses must stay proactive in understanding and adhering to these new laws and regulations. By prioritizing compliance, businesses can navigate the complexities of these business environments and foster trust, sustainability, and inclusivity in their operations.

Disclaimer: This article is not meant as legal advice. It is solely for educational purposes.

Miller is the managing partner of Miller Haga Law Group, LLC in Calabasas. She is a highly-recognized legal advisor, published author, noted speaker and panelist with over 25 years of experience as an innovative general counsel in business, real estate, entertainment, and intellectual property.

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HEALTH

"Eldest Daughter Syndrome" Breaking the Internet

It's a phrase that has recently broken the internet, but any first-born daughter may already be all too familiar with the meaning behind "eldest daughter syndrome."



While not an official medical term, the phrase is used to describe the emotional weight that first-born daughters often carry in their family dynamics. Although it is not a new concept, this widely recognized phenomenon has recently gained traction on the internet, with many identifying and even joking about their personal situations. One such eldest daughter tweeted, "If you identify as the eldest daughter, you may be entitled to compensation."

While numerous studies have dissected birth order stereotypes, "eldest daughter syndrome" essentially boils down to the "the unique pressures and responsibilities placed onto the oldest daughter in the family" who often take on the role of eldest sibling and additional parent.

Molly M. Fox, PhD, from the Department of Anthropology at the University of California, Los Angeles, highlights the historical fact that it was the standard throughout much of history for eldest daughters to lend a helping hand in the family. First-born daughters tend to mature faster and thus, are leaned upon to help in rearing their younger siblings.

Research has pointed out that those who relate to the "eldest daughter syndrome" typically have an intense feeling of responsibility, are typically overachievers, have more-than-average anxiety, are people-pleasers and struggle with placing boundaries. Researchers did not find the same results in males or daughters who were not first-born. Additionally, this term is more relevant to a first-born daughter that has younger siblings.

While the current jokes trending on the internet are mostly in the negative realm, "eldest daughter syndrome" can result in a multitude of positives, such as those daughters more likely to end up in leadership positions with strong priority management, nurturing skills and resilience. The skills that they had to utilize while growing up with, and taking care of, their younger siblings are ones that are now easily transferable to facets in their adult life. Eldest daughters are also more likely to succeed than their siblings.

While "eldest daughter syndrome" is a colloquial term, scientific evidence does point to parental expectations, sibling relationships and societal pressures that give significant weight to this trending term.

Stereotypically, firstborn children tend to be reliable and high-achieving; middle children are sociable and rebellious and youngest children are the most charming. While birth order is certainly not a definite answer to one's personality, and cannot be scientifically proven, anyone with brothers and sisters may feel like this all hits a little too close to home.





COVID-19 Vaccine Shown to Not Be Cause of Cardiac Death in Young Adults

With the speed at which COVID vaccines were produced, as well as news breaking events, many have speculated if the COVID vaccine is behind cardiac deaths in young adults.

This speculation was heightened when Buffalo Bills safety Damar Hamlin collapsed on the field after experiencing a cardiac arrest in 2023. While health professionals pointed to the very specific blow he sustained, the event only exaggerated the vaccine theory.

Thus, a CDC study was undertaken to analyze the connection between those who had received the vaccine and cardiac arrest in young adults. The study published in early April analyzed over 1,300 death certificates of individuals aged 16 to 30 who died from cardiac arrest between 2021 and 2022. In the 100 days after receiving the vaccine, 40 died; two of those due to underlying illness and one from an "undetermined cause of death." The deaths of the other individuals were due to COVID-19 and being unvaccinated .

"The data do not support an association of COVID-19 vaccination with sudden cardiac death among previously healthy young persons," the CDC said in the report.

While the COVID vaccine has been linked to a minor risk of heart inflammation, called myocarditis, it is typically mild and most people fully recover in a few days.

Poorly Named, but Beneficial for Your Health – How the "Fart Walk" is Trending

First the internet made the "hot girl walk" popular and now, Tik Tok has a new fitness movement trending dubbed the "fart walk."

While not the most eloquently named fitness trend, gastroenterologists have spoken on the surprising health benefits of this social media craze.

Gastroenterologists stress the importance digestion plays in properly processing food and reducing bloat. One manner of helping this process along is to engage in gentle exercise after eating since the GI tract moves when your body moves. Cue the "fart walk."

While not the most eloquently named fitness trend, gastroenterologists have spoken on the surprising health benefits of this social media craze.

When an individual walks, they are aiding the motility part of the digestive tract that allows the food consumed to be broken down efficiently and effectively.

According to a study in the American Journal of Gastroenterology, mild activity after a meal is enough to significantly reduce bloating, while also lessening heartburn and keeping your blood sugar in check. While some may feel relief passing gas on their walk, the idea is more to incorporate a little bit of exercise after eating to kick start these benefits. Just 10 minutes at a gentle pace can significantly aid one's digestion.

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HEALTH

With Spring, "Allergy Headaches" are on the Rise

Tension, cluster, migraines…there are numerous variations of the common headache, but have you heard of the allergy headache?



While not a scientific diagnosis, allergy headaches tend to rise during the start of spring when pollen, dust and debris in the air is heightened. Allergy headaches usually fall into one of two categories: sinus or migraines but the difference can be hard to tell and most times they are interchangeable.

Inflammation of the sinuses, often called rhinosinusitis or sinusitis, typically affects the areas around one's eyes and nose. While true rhinosinusitis is caused by an infection, allergy rhinitis is typically caused by allergens in the air. These environmental factors typically trigger headaches given the stuffiness caused in the upper region of the head that is the body's natural response of defense.

An allergy headache often feels like a dull or throbbing pain in the temples or forehead and throughout the nose and cheekbone areas - all areas where your sinuses are located.

The symptoms of rhinosinusitis are similar to those of a migraine and around 90% of patients who believe they have a sinus headache are actually diagnosed with migraine instead. Migraines occur when nerve fibers in the blood vessels of the brain become activated and histamine is released causing inflammation and irritation of nasal passages.

People with inflammation caused by allergies are more than 10 times as likely to have migraines and women are three times as likely to be affected than men.

Typical irritants like pollen, dust and pet dander can cause your body to react with a sinus migraine even if you have no other symptoms. It is also important to note that not everyone who experiences allergic symptoms will have headaches.

While over-the-counter allergy medication can help alleviate symptoms, experts suggest also drinking lots of fluids and ingesting a small amount of caffeine when you feel the migraine is just coming on. Caffeine has vasoconstrictive properties, which causes blood vessels to narrow and restrict blood flow, thereby alleviating pain. If the migraine persists or worsens, extracting yourself from the triggering environment and laying down with a cold compress can help mitigate the symptoms.

Allergy shots, nasal decongestants and knowing what your specific allergy triggers are (and avoiding them), can prevent allergy headaches from starting and the migraine that typically comes with it.

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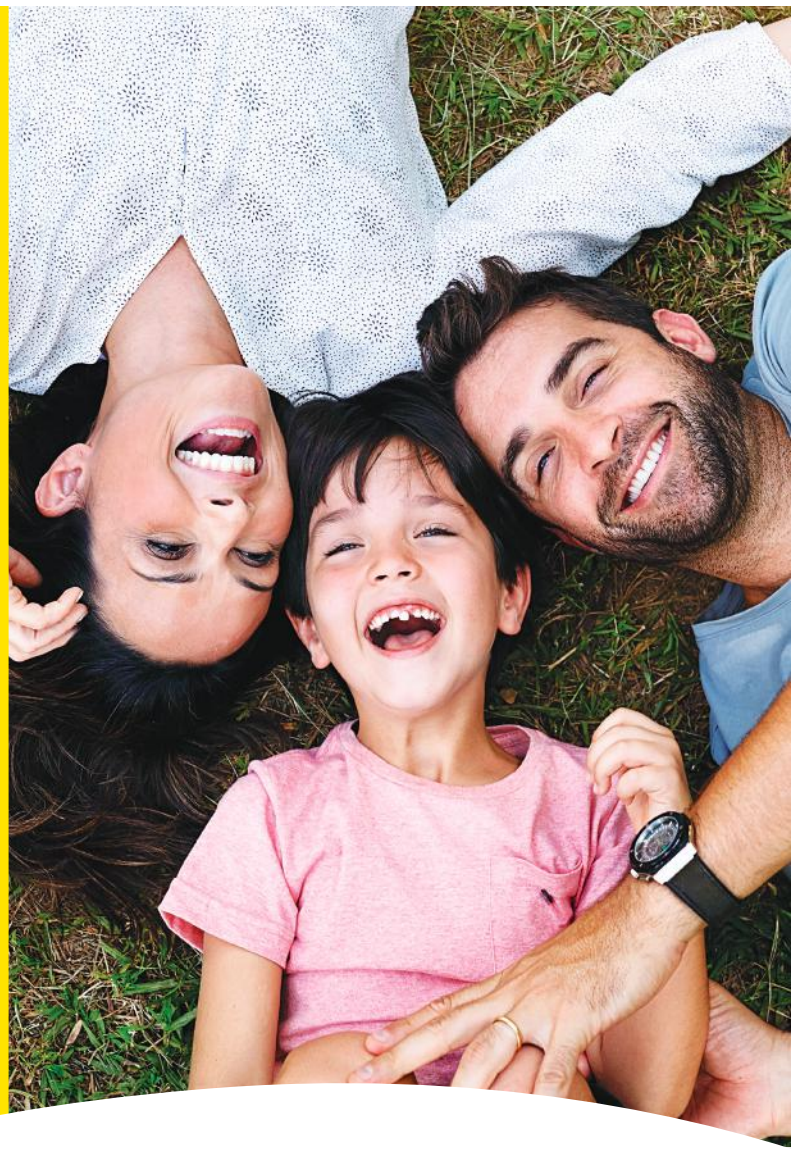
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The Reel History of the Valley

By Martin M. Cooper

The Valley's First Film

The first known motion picture made in Los Angeles was filmed on December 31, 1897, when Frederick Blechynden set up his motion picture camera and filmed 25 seconds of traffic on South Spring Street for the Edison Manufacturing Company. The street is shared by horse-drawn carriages, a trolley, bicyclists, and hardy jaywalkers.

Just 13 years later, the San Fernando Valley made its film debut. As far as anyone knows, the first film shot in the San Fernando Valley was D.W. Griffith's *Over Silent Paths*, released by Biograph on May 16, 1910 (available on YouTube.com).

Subtitled *A Story of the American Desert, Over Silent Paths* was shot at the Mission San Fernando Rey de España, which was established in 1797 in the north end of the Valley. There are two brief shots of the Mission's arches, which still exist.

The 16-minute Western takes place in the desert where an old miner is panning for gold while his daughter keeps his camp tidy. Two horses and the wagon the couple obviously use for transportation are in the background.



The title card for *Over Silent Paths*.

Having been successful in their quest, the duo prepares to decamp for civilization. As the girl goes to fetch water for their final meal, a wanderer appears and sees the miner weighing his gold nuggets. In a struggle for the gold, the miner falls, hits his head and dies. Remorse from killing the miner doesn't prevent the wanderer from making off with the gold.

Returning with her water, the girl is horrified to see her murdered father, and while burying him, vows to bring his killer to justice.

Meanwhile, the murderer has become lost and disoriented and would have died in the desert had not the grieving daughter rescued him, totally unaware that the man she rescued had, not long before, killed her father.

They ride into town together, pausing at a primitive street sign that reads "San Fernando Road." Neither knows of the relationship of the other to the murdered miner, and, not surprisingly, the murderer falls in love with the girl. While proposing, to demonstrate his suitability for marriage, he shows the girl the bags of gold he has stolen, sure that she will think of them as his own.

Recognizing the bags as those of her father, she nearly faints, pretends to accept the wanderer's proposal, steals his gun, and then marches him off to the local sheriff (the title card calls him the sheriff, but the sign above the doorway reads "U.S. Marshall"). In the final shot, the daughter returns to her father's grave, and says, "I did it, Dad."


Billy Bitzer at the camera with a bundled-up D.W. Griffith in the snow.

Although uncredited – as were all actors in the early 20th century – the lead in *Over Silent Paths* was Marion Leonard, who starred in a number of Griffith's films. She retired from acting in 1915, having made more than 150 pictures. She died at the Motion Picture Country Home in Woodland Hills on January 9, 1956, at age 74.

Others in the cast were, Dell Henderson (The Wanderer), W. Chrystie Miller (The Father), and Arthur V. Johnson (The Sheriff).

Among the cast, the only memorable name was that of Mack Sennett, who became the noted producer and director of the Keystone Kops and Charlie Chaplin. By the time Sennett appeared in *Over Silent Paths*, he had acted in nearly 200 films.

The cinematographer who shot *Over Silent Paths* was Griffith's long-time associate, Billy Bitzer, who was born Johann Gottfried Wilhelm Bitzer. The duo is credited with more film innovations than anyone else in the history of film.

Bitzer shot his first picture of note in 1896. His film of William McKinley being notified of his party's presidential nomination was exhibited on the Biograph Company's first program. He became the first motion-picture cameraman to cover a war, filming the Spanish-American War for William Randolph Hearst's corporation.

Bitzer filmed more than 400 pictures for Griffith between *The Adventures of Dollie* in 1908 and *Lady of the Pavements* in 1929.

A survey conducted by the International Cinematographers Guild in 2003 called Bitzer one of the 10 most influential cinematographers in history, and credited him with having "developed camera techniques that set the standard for all future motion pictures."

The first use of artificial light was photographed by Bitzer for 1903's *Rip Van Winkle*. Just a few of his other innovations include matte photography, groundbreaking lighting techniques, dissolve effects, closeups, split-screen photography, and iris shots.

The team of Griffith and Bitzer was no doubt unaware of it, but they paved the way for the 260-square-mile basin of the San Fernando Valley to become the Mother Lode of moviemaking.

Martin Cooper, President of Cooper Communications, supervised public relations for the Academy of Motion Picture Arts & Sciences for 10 years; held executive positions with Disney and Universal Studios; and served as Chairman of the Board of the UCLA Film & Television Archive.

An award-winning author, he has written four books, two of them on the San Fernando Valley. He is currently researching his next book on the Valley.


Marion Leonard, the uncredited star of *Over Silent Paths*.

ENTERTAINMENT

Sharing Our Secret Getaway...

By Kathleen Sterling

We really don't want to share our secret weekend getaway, but we promised the owners we'd cover their grand reopening.

Remember the rogue wave that hit Ventura in December? We watched in horror as a massive wave crashed through the ground floor of our favorite boutique hotel and washed up through Seaward Avenue, sending eight people to the hospital.

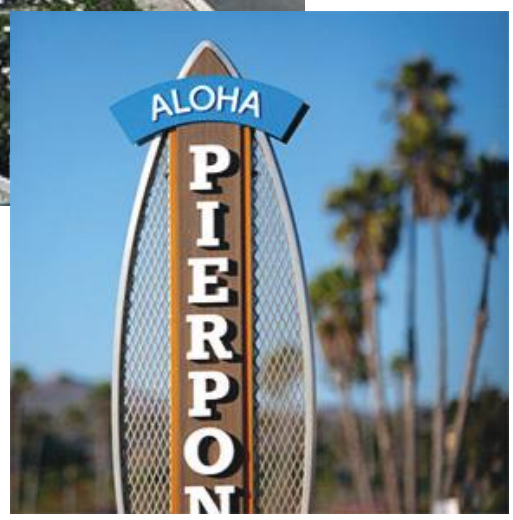
Months later and after much work by owner Judy Thomas and longtime manager Jay Williams the hotel has reopened to loyal customers ready to return to this little hidden bit of paradise.

Because even before the remodel, Inn on the Beach was a find. It literally sits right on the sand at the end of Seaward, and all 24 rooms face the ocean.



For such an amazing vista, the beach is never that crowded, and the views are incredible. You can see up and down the coast, from the Ventura Pier to the north down south to the jetty, and across the ocean to the Channel Islands.





At the end of the day we love to sit on our balcony and watch the gorgeous sunsets, as the sun flames down into the sea. My joy comes as we see dolphins dance their way up the coast.



Rooms at Inn on the Beach are quaint, with old-fashioned floral wallpaper, antique armoires and built-in fireplaces in each room. The beds and bathrooms have been upgraded since the closure, and the rooms are comfortable and cozy, especially when the fireplaces are on to ward off the chill – as we've stayed here during every season! I actually love staying during the winter, when the beach is deserted and we can just snuggle in with a glass of wine and watch for my dolphins.





In truth, this is the perfect place to relax and unwind, and you never even have to leave Seaward Ave.







Clockwise from the top: The Inn on the Beach sits right on the sand; Everything is within walking distance at Pierpont; The view from our third-floor room; Grilled cheese from Paradise Pantry; Tacos from Pierpont Tacos; Big burger from Social Tap; Dolphins can be seen right off the beach; Amazing sunsets are a highlight, and center, a guest room at Inn on the Beach.

There's a big Von's at the east end of the street for provisions. Those that can't ever go without can hit Starbucks in the same center.

A continental breakfast of cereal, muffins and pastries is served in the breakfast room of the hotel, but for lunch and dinner there are dining options right out the front door.

A favorite place to hang for happy hour and dinner is Social Tap. Literally a two-minute walk away from the hotel, Social Tap offers a great pub atmosphere and food. Large televisions screen sports, and the big bar is always crowded with both visitors and locals alike, enjoying the daily specials, full bar, and their beer flights. Every day there's a $5 beer of the day featuring a new brew, a $9 rotator on tap and $10 slushies.

There's bar food like tacos and wings, but also huge burgers, fish and chips, burritos and sandwiches, and also salads and a great chicken tortilla soup. Social Tap is now serving Sunday brunch, which is a great go-to after a sound sleep listening to the waves wash up on the beach at the hotel.

For a quick lunch, there's the famous Pierpont Tacos, literally right next door. Everyone in Ventura knows their amazing offerings – try the fish tacos or my fave – the queso taco, just loaded with cheesy goodness. The tiny restaurant is definitely a go-to for any visitor.

When inspired by the ocean we hit Duke's across the street for clam chowder or fried shrimp.

We do venture out during the day to Main Street Ventura, to check out the little boutiques, funky thrift stores, antique stores and restaurants that line the pedestrian-only section of the main drag.

Creatures of habit, we always stop at Paradise Pantry for their insane grilled cheese sandwich and spicy fish soup.

Owner/chef Kelly Briglio serves up a menu of amazing sandwiches and salads – plus a killer mac and cheese. We usually start with the pantry bruschetta, which offers large pieces of grilled ciabatta with cheese, walnut pesto and oven-roasted tomatoes. But it's the grilled cheese that keeps us coming back – rosemary Jack and aged cheddar with caramelized onions. To die for.

Partner Tina Thayer is in charge of our other favorite portion of Paradise Pantry. They offer a wine and cheese store right on site, with a great selection of both local and international wines, and oh! the cheeses…

I love to order a charcuterie plate to go, pick up a bottle of wine, and head back to Inn on the Beach to watch the sunset from the balcony, nibbling on cheese and enjoying a new vintage discovered at Paradise Pantry.

Inn on the Beach is just a half an hour away from the valley, but worlds' away from the stress and strain of work and reality. I don't sleep well at home, but there, listening to the waves break on the sand I sleep like a baby. Waking up to dolphins playing in the water is a dream.

We've come to Inn on the Beach for years, and always loved our secret vacation spot.

We're sharing the newly remodeled version now with our readers, so you too can escape the heat of the valley and head to Ventura – and a perfect weekend getaway of your own!

Inn on the Beach is located at 1175 Seaward Avenue. There is free parking and free wifi. Editor's note: Book a room on the second or third floor for ocean views. Call (805) 652-2000 or visit innonthebeachventura.com.

Gabriel Applauds $6 Million in Security Grants for the Valley

Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel recently announced that the State of California has awarded $40 million in security grants to nonprofits facing hate motivated violence — including over $6 million awarded to nonprofits serving residents of Assembly District 46 in the San Fernando Valley.

In total, 29 nonprofits that serve Assembly District 46 residents were awarded $6.1 million for critical security enhancements to their facilities. Nearly $3 million in funding was allocated to nonprofits located within Assembly District 46, including the Holy Martyrs Armenian Apostolic Church in Encino, the AGBU Manoogian-Demirdjian School in Canoga Park, Valley Beth Shalom in Encino, Valley Presbyterian Hospital in Van Nuys, Crespi Carmelite High School in Encino, De Toledo High School in West Hills, and Chabad of the Valley in Tarzana.

"I'm grateful that the State of California is providing critical security funding to so many worthy nonprofits across the San Fernando Valley," said Gabriel, who serves as Co-Chair of the Legislative Jewish Caucus and who authored the legislation to create the NSGP. "California will not stand idly by as hate and antisemitism continue to rise and while our vulnerable communities are threatened by extremists. This security funding will support critical security enhancements at institutions most in need and will make it clear that California stands with all communities targeted by hate."

The NSGP has provided critical security funding to nonprofits at risk of hate-motivated violence – including $140 million over the last three state budget cycles. This year's awards total $40 million.

In 2019, Assemblymember Gabriel authored AB 1548, which created the NSGP. He authored AB 1664 in 2022, which made the NSGP permanent, increased the maximum grant to $500,000, and allowed funding to be used for security training. Last year Gabriel authored AB 1185, which broadens the reach of the NSGP and helps to ensure that funding is directed to applicants who are most likely to be targeted by hate-motivated violence.

The NSGP has become the most popular grant administered by the Governor's Office of Emergency Services and has been a critical lifeline for diverse faith communities, LGBTQ community centers, reproductive health facilities, and other nonprofits facing hate-motivated violence.



City Council Calls for a Van Nuys Airport Citizens Advisory Committee

On February 20, the LA City Council adopted a motion (Council File No. 23-1339) that mandates the development of a new Van Nuys Airport (VNY) Specific Plan. This plan will consider existing environmental, aeronautical, economical and home environment interests of the City, specifically the Valley.

The motion also mandates the formation of the VNY Specific Plan Citizens Advisory Committee which will include at least one representative from CD 2, CD 3, CD 4, CD 5, CD 6 and CD 12.

Council District 6 will be responsible for the formation and operation of this committee. Residents should contact their respective Neighborhood Council to submit their interest in participating on the committee. For organizational and vetting purposes, only candidates submitted by each qualifying Neighborhood Council President will be considered. For those interested, one mandated qualifying criteria for candidates listed is their ability to demonstrate that they reside in the district their respective Neighborhood Council represents. The deadline for submissions is May 6, 2024.





Sat May 4 | 8pm

Culture Clash

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The iconoclastic Chicano performance troupe proudly returns to The Soraya with an all-new show that serves up an **explosive cocktail of humor and satirical outrage**. This eclectic group of California natives has profoundly explored the evolution of **LatinX culture on stages and screens for four decades**. The historic anniversary performance, "May the 40th Be With You," dares you not to laugh out loud. The legacy of Culture Clash lives at CSUN both onstage as well as in the University Library Special Collections and Archives, where a significant multi-volume set of their documents and letters live and breathe.

TheSorayaStage | TheSoraya.org